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"My rate is \$150/hour."

That sentence is why your buyer chose someone cheaper.

Hourly billing puts you in a price war you cannot win.

May 1, 2026

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You quote \$150/hr. The intern quotes \$80/hr.

The buyer can't see your decade of pattern recognition.

They see two numbers. They pick the smaller one. Your expertise becomes invisible.

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Buyers don't want your hours.

They want the outcome at the end of them.

Price the transformation, not the time. Authority lives in the result, not the clock.

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4 invisible taxes hourly billing charges you:

- The Comparison Tax — benchmarked vs juniors
- The Speed Penalty — faster = less money
- The Ceiling Tax — capped at 168 hrs/wk
- The Authority Tax — sounds like a vendor, not an expert

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Hourly: "I charge \$150/hr."

Outcome: "Stop discounting in 60 days. \$8,500."

One competes with juniors. The other competes with the cost of staying stuck. Different ceiling.



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Open your proposal template right now.

Delete the hourly rate.

Replace it with the outcome and a fixed price. If a buyer insists on hourly, they're buying a body, not your expertise.

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Comment "BRAND"

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